IDEA School Server: Installation Manual

Raspberry Pi 5 Engines + Cudy router + PoE switch + Starlink

For Justice. Version 1.2, 15 October 2026

IDEA - offline school computing. Prepared for Koen Swings's team.
No real passwords, keys or tokens are included; values in <ANGLE BRACKETS> are placeholders.

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How to use this manual

This manual takes one school from boxes to a working IDEA server. Each step has the same shape:

1. **Do:** what to do.
2. ✔ **Check:** how to see that it worked. Go on once the check passes.

> **Placeholders.** This manual has no secret keys or tokens in it. Wherever you see `<SOMETHING>`, use your own value. Keep the real values in your password manager, not in this PDF. The IDEA default passwords below are not secret: they follow the public IDEA convention `<name>911!`.
>
> - IDEA defaults: router `root` / `admin911!`, switch `admin` / `admin911!`, Pi user `pi` / `pi911!` (keyboard only; SSH is key-only), classroom computer `admin` / `admin911!`, Wi-Fi `IDEA` / `idea911!` and `IDEA-Teachers` / `idea-teachers911!`.
> - `<TAILSCALE-AUTH-KEY>`: the one IDEA fleet key. Koen gives it to you as a file. Keep it in the file: it stays out of the command history.
> - `<STICKER>`: the name the installer gives a Pi, for example `brave-otter` (section 5.6). Write it on the sticker on the case.

> **How many Engines?** Not fixed. A school starts with **one** Engine and can add or remove Engines at any time. The router needs no change when Engines come or go: it gives every Engine an address from `10.42.0.2` to `.9` and answers `idea.local` with the Engines that are on. Where this manual says "each Pi", do the step once per Engine.

> **No school numbers.** Every school uses the same addresses, and a Pi's name is its sticker name, not a number. A Pi can move to another school without any change in Tailscale or in this manual.

The school router's Wi-Fi networks and default passwords

The Wi-Fi networks the router makes, and their first passwords.

The IDEA school router arrives **pre-flashed** (see the IDEA School Router – Image and Automated Flashing proposal). It already has these settings:

What	Name	Default password	Who uses it
Student Wi-Fi	`IDEA`	`idea911!`	Students' and classroom computers and phones. Reaches **only** the Pis (Console, Kolibri, Nextcloud, Kiwix). No internet.
Teacher Wi-Fi	`IDEA-Teachers`	`idea-teachers911!`	Teachers. Reaches the Pis. Internet is **on** by default; staff can switch it off (section 9).

What	Name	Default password	Who uses it
Router admin (LuCI and SSH on the wired LAN)	user `root`	`admin911!`	The installer and the IDEA team only. Over Tailscale the router accepts SSH keys only.

Give the students the `IDEA` network and its password. Give only the teachers the `IDEA-Teachers` network and its password.

> **Change the passwords later.** The defaults are easy on purpose, so a school can start straight away, but anyone who knows the `<name>911!` pattern can guess them. Once the school is running, the head teacher picks new Wi-Fi passwords and the IDEA team changes them on the router (section 10). Write the new ones down and keep them safe.

Fill-in sheet for this school

Write down the details of this school as you go.

Item	Value
School name	____
Router	`10.42.0.1`, hostname `idea-router`
Engine 1 (switch port 1)	address 10.42.0.____ (the router gives Engines `.2` to `.9`), sticker name _____
Engine 2 (port 2, if fitted)	address 10.42.0.____, sticker name _____
Engine 3 (port 3, if fitted)	address 10.42.0.____, sticker name _____
Engine 4 (port 4, if fitted)	address 10.42.0.____, sticker name _____
Starlink kit	router generation (Gen 3 / Gen 2 / Mini) _____, bypass on ☐; account: **IDEA project** (pays the subscription)
Switch	`10.42.0.10`, MAC (on its label) _:_:_:_:_:_
Wi-Fi students	SSID `IDEA`, password `idea911!` (until changed), subnet `10.42.1.0/24`
Wi-Fi teachers	SSID `IDEA-Teachers`, password `idea-teachers911!` (until changed), subnet `10.42.2.0/24`
Tailscale tag	`tag:idea` (the same for every school)
Cudy serial number (label)	____ (date code: _____)

Why three subnets? The wired network of the router and the Pis is `10.42.0.0/24`, the same at every school. Two separate firewall zones need two separate networks, so the Wi-Fi networks get `10.42.1.0/24` (IDEA) and `10.42.2.0/24` (IDEA-Teachers). Schools are never joined by a network (IDEA has no subnet routes), so the same addresses everywhere cause no clash.

The big picture

How the parts fit together.

Wiring

Which cable goes where.

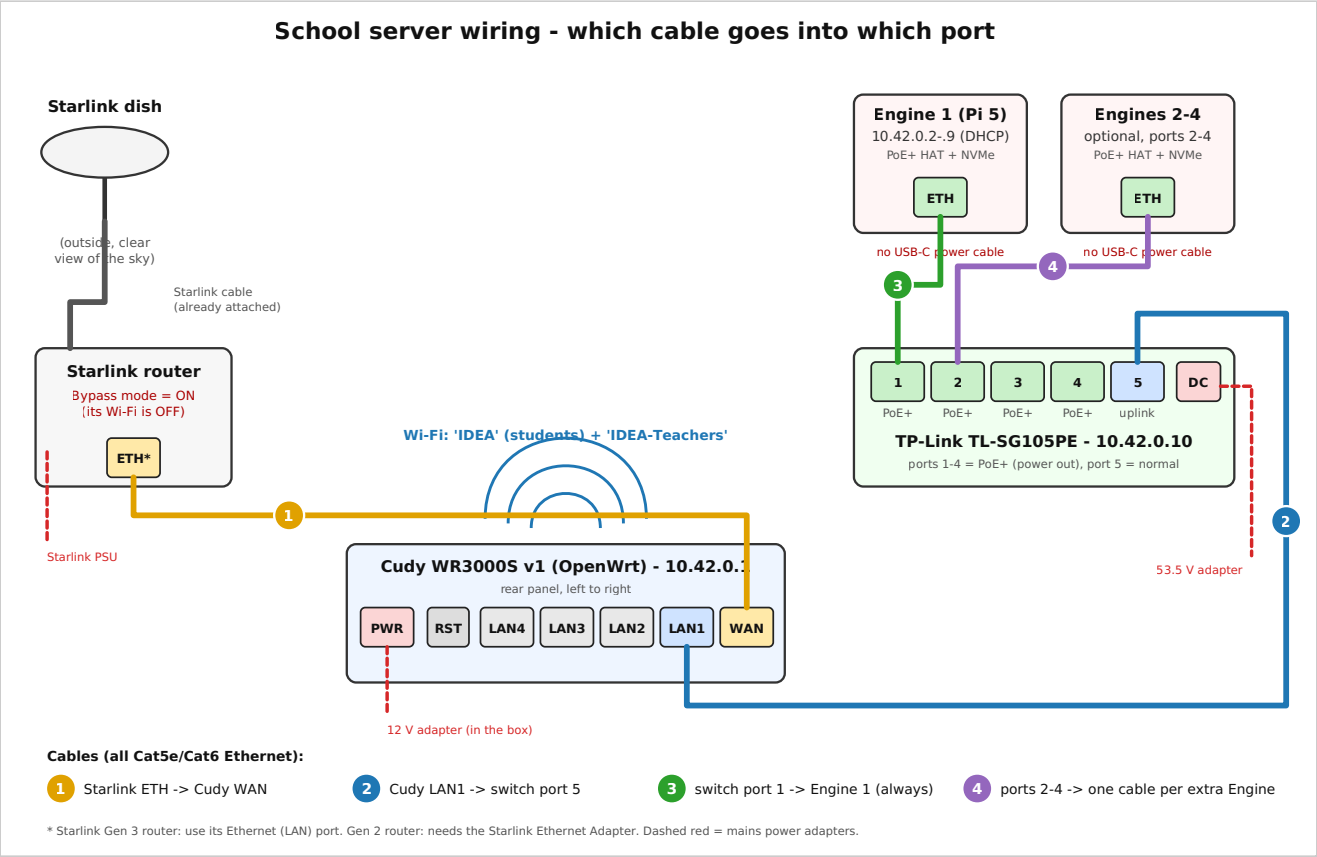


Figure 1. Wiring diagram: which cable goes into which port

Cable	From	To	Notes
1	Starlink router, Ethernet port	Cudy **WAN** port (yellow)	Gen 3 router: built-in LAN port. Gen 2: Starlink Ethernet Adapter needed.
2	Cudy **LAN1**	Switch **port 5**	Port 5 is the only port without PoE. Use it for the uplink.
3	Switch **port 1** (PoE+)	Engine 1 Ethernet	This cable powers Engine 1. Every school has at least this one.
4…	Switch **ports 2, 3, 4** (PoE+)	Engines 2, 3, 4 (if the school has them)	One cable per extra Engine. Leave unused ports empty.

The Pis get **no** USB-C power supply. The PoE+ HAT takes power from the Ethernet cable. A free switch port can also take an extra access point instead of an Engine.

Network zones

Who can reach what on the school network.

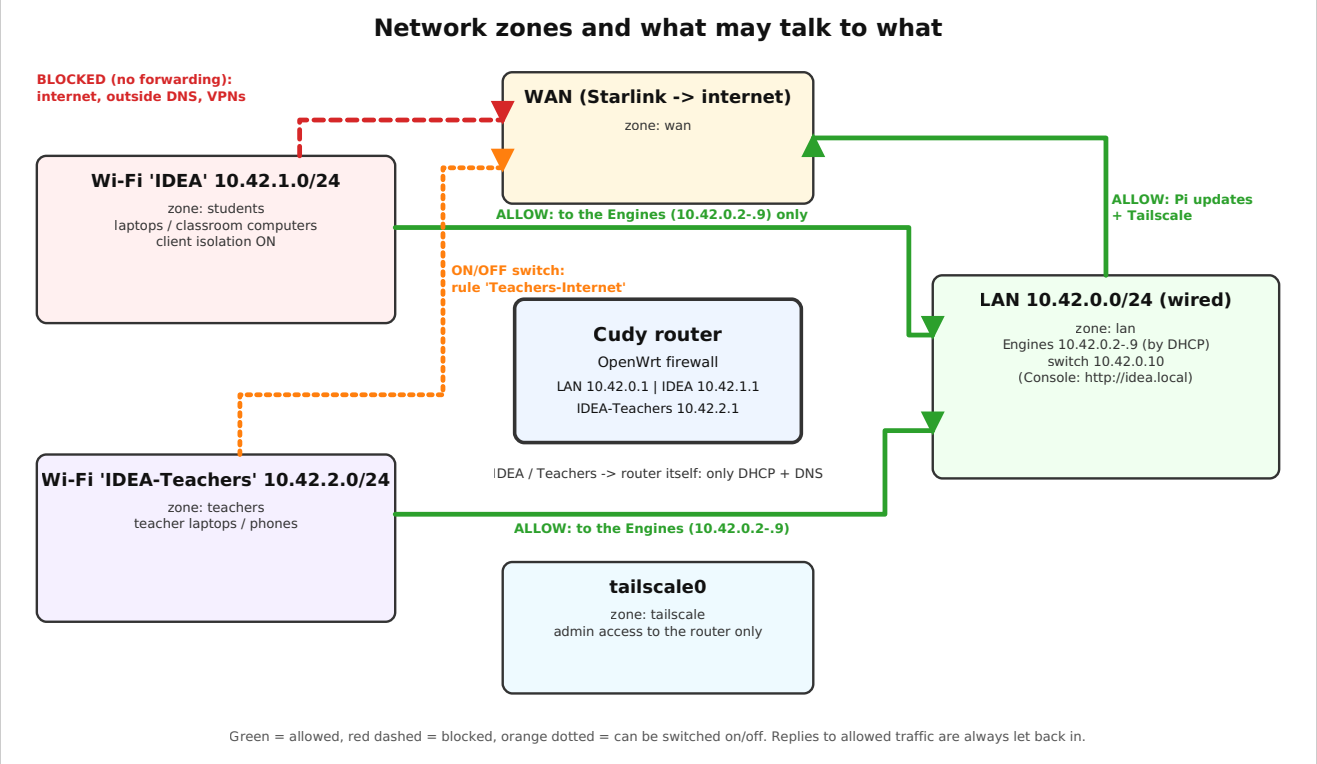


Figure 2. Network zones and allowed traffic

- **IDEA (students):** devices reach only the Engines, however many there are (Console, Kolibri, Nextcloud, Kiwix). There is no forwarding to the internet, so outside DNS servers, VPNs and websites are all blocked. Students on the IDEA Wi-Fi cannot reach each other either (client isolation).
- **IDEA-Teachers:** devices reach the Pis. Internet goes through **one** firewall rule, `Teachers-Internet`, which staff can switch off and on again (section 9). It starts **on**.
- **LAN (wired):** the Pis may reach the internet for updates and Tailscale. They do not route traffic for anyone else.
- **Tailscale:** the router and every Engine join the IDEA tailnet with the one fleet tag `tag:idea`. Admins reach every device. Devices with `tag:idea` reach nothing, not even each other. There are no exit nodes and no subnet routes.

Where to do each step

Which steps you do in Belgium and which on site.

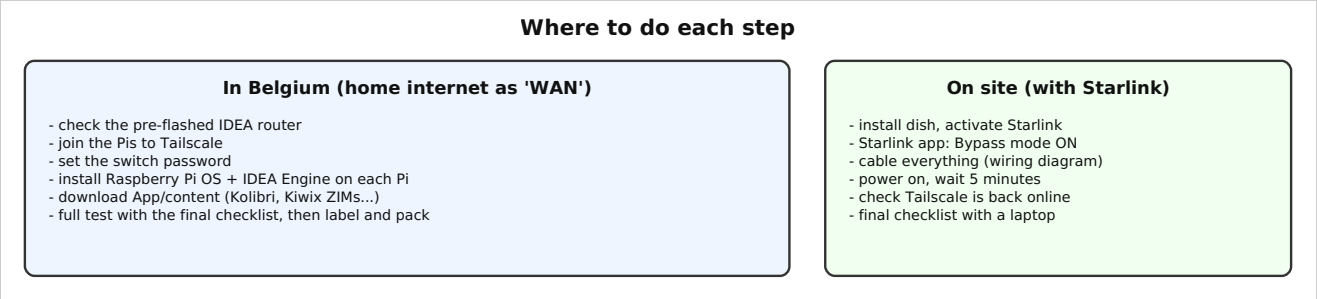


Figure 3. Belgium vs on site

Do everything you can **in Belgium**, with your home internet plugged into the Cudy WAN port in place of Starlink. Your home router gives the Cudy a WAN address (for example 192.168.x.x). That does not clash with 10.42.x.x. Then the only jobs left on site are Starlink, cables and checks.

Section	Belgium	On site
1 Unbox and check contents	✔	
2 Check the pre-flashed router	✔	
3 Router: internet and Tailscale check	✔	
4 Switch password and watchdog	✔	
5 Pi OS and IDEA Engine, Tailscale on Pis	✔ (needs internet)	
6 Tailscale policy (Koen)	✔	
7 Connect Starlink and final cabling		✔
8 Final checklist	✔ (dry run)	✔ (for real)

1. Unboxing

Check that the school kit is complete.

Do this once for each school kit. Tick each item.

☐	Item	What to look for
☐	Cudy WR3000S router + 12 V adapter + Ethernet cable	Label underneath says **WR3000S** and **V1.0**; IDEA sticker with the router name (see 2.1)
☐	TP-Link TL-SG105PE switch + 53.5 V adapter	Ports 1-4 marked PoE+
☐	N× Raspberry Pi 5 (N = number of Engines for this school; usually 1 to start)	Write N on the fill-in sheet
☐	N× blank stickers (or labels) and a permanent marker	For the sticker names (5.6)
☐	N× PoE+ HAT with NVMe slot (or PoE+ HAT + M.2 HAT) + N× NVMe SSD	Write the HAT model and its rated output (for example 5 V 4.5 A) on the fill-in sheet. See 5.1.
☐	N+1 Ethernet patch cables (Cat5e/ Cat6), 0.5-2 m	One for each Engine plus one for the router-switch link
☐	Plug adapters for Zimbabwe (Type G / Type D sockets)	Belgian plugs (Type E/F) don't fit Zimbabwe sockets
☐	Power strip, ideally with surge protection	A small UPS is a good idea where the power often cuts out (optional)
☐	Starlink kit (dish, router, cable, PSU)	Note the router generation. Gen 3 has an Ethernet port. Gen 2 needs the Starlink Ethernet Adapter: if the kit has no adapter, stop and tell Koen.

✔ **Check:** every row is ticked. Write the Cudy serial number on the fill-in sheet.

2. Router: check the pre-flashed IDEA router

Check that the router arrived with the IDEA settings.

The IDEA team flashes and sets up every router before it ships, with the flash script from the IDEA School Router – Image and Automated Flashing proposal. You do **not** flash it yourself. If you ever get a plain Cudy router that is not pre-flashed, follow Appendix D instead.

2.1 Read the labels

Note the router's model and serial number.

1. Turn the Cudy over. The Cudy label shows the model (**WR3000S**), the hardware version (**V1.0**) and the serial number. Write the serial number on the fill-in sheet.
2. The IDEA sticker shows the router's own name, the Wi-Fi name `IDEA`, the password `idea911!` and `http://10.42.0.1`.

✔ **Check:** the Cudy label says WR3000S V1.x and there is an IDEA sticker. If there is no IDEA sticker, the router is not pre-flashed: tell Koen, or use Appendix D.

2.2 Check the IDEA settings

See that the router's IDEA settings are in place.

1. Connect the 12 V adapter. Connect your laptop with a cable to **LAN2**. Leave WAN empty.
2. Browse to `http://10.42.0.1` and log in as `root` with `admin911!`.

✔ **Check (all four):**

- Your laptop gets `10.42.0.1xx`. The LuCI page footer shows the IDEA image version.
- **Network → Wireless** lists `IDEA` and `IDEA-Teachers` on both radios, all enabled.
- A phone can join `IDEA` with `idea911!` and gets an address `10.42.1.x`.
- **Network → Firewall → Traffic Rules** lists `Teachers-Internet`, ticked (on).

> **Factory reset.** Holding the reset button gives back these IDEA defaults (Wi-Fi, passwords, firewall, `10.42.0.1`), not plain OpenWrt. So a reset never leaves a school with an open network, but it does undo password changes from section 10.

3. Router: internet and Tailscale check

Check that the router reaches the internet and the IDEA team.

1. Plug your home router (Belgium) or the Starlink router (on site) into the Cudy **WAN** port.
2. LuCI **Status → Overview** should show an IPv4 WAN address.

✔ **Check:**

- `ssh root@10.42.0.1 'ping -c3 openwrt.org'` gets replies.
- `ssh root@10.42.0.1 tailscale status` shows the router online. The flash script already joined it to the tailnet with `tag:idea`; you do not need the fleet key for the router.
- In the Tailscale admin console the router shows with its sticker name and tag `tag:idea`.

4. Switch: TP-Link TL-SG105PE (optional, recommended)

Set up the switch that powers the Engines.

Facts from TP-Link [7][8]:

- 5 gigabit ports. Ports 1-4 are 802.3af/at PoE+, up to 30 W each, **65 W in total**.
- It gets its IP address by DHCP. If there is no DHCP server, it falls back to `192.168.0.1`.
- The factory login is user `admin`, password `admin`. This is a public factory default, printed in TP-Link's guide, and you will replace it.
- **PoE Auto Recovery** pings a device and power-cycles its port when the device stops answering. It is off by default.

1. Connect switch port 5 to Cudy LAN1. Power the switch. Wait 1 minute.
2. Find the switch in LuCI **Status → Overview → Active DHCP Leases**. Click **Set Static** and give it `10.42.0.10`. Then power-cycle the switch.
3. Browse to `http://10.42.0.10`. Log in with the factory default. **System → User Account**: set the IDEA default `admin911!`.
4. Optional watchdog, under **PoE → PoE Auto Recovery**: * Enable it globally. * For each port with an Engine: Ping IP = that Engine's address from the fill-in sheet. (The router normally keeps giving an Engine the same address; if you move Engines between ports, update this.) * **Startup Delay 300 s** (a Pi takes a few minutes to boot and start the Engine) * Interval 60 s, Failure Threshold 5, Break Time 15 s

✔ **Check:** you can log in with the new password and the old one fails. PoE Status shows every port with an Engine "on" with a few watts each once the Pis are connected.

> The switch is not on Tailscale, so nobody can reach it from outside the school. The watchdog is the only automatic power reset. An admin can still reach its web page through a Pi with an SSH tunnel: `ssh -L 8080:10.42.0.10:80 pi@<pi-tailscale-ip>`, then open `http://localhost:8080`.

5. The Raspberry Pi 5 Engines (one or more)

Build and install each Engine.

Do this section once per Engine. A school with one Engine does it once; you can add Engines later the same way.

5.1 Assemble

Put the Engine's parts together.

1. Fit the NVMe SSD and the PoE+ HAT, following the HAT maker's instructions. Fit any cooling the HAT comes with.
2. Do **not** connect a USB-C power supply at the same time as PoE.

> **USB power.** Background (Raspberry Pi docs [9]): a Pi 5 gives USB devices 1.6 A only when it detects a 5 A supply. Otherwise it limits USB to 600 mA. Common PoE+/M.2 HATs for the Pi 5 supply 5 V / 4.5 A (for example Waveshare [10]). So a **USB-powered App Disk (SSD)** may not get enough current. Do not raise the limit (`PSU_MAX_CURRENT` in the EEPROM [11]) unless the HAT's label or datasheet says 5 A. If App Disks are USB SSDs, test them under load in Belgium: copy a large file to the disk and check that `vcgencmd get_throttled` still prints `throttled=0x0`.

5.2 Install Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit) on the NVMe

Put the operating system on the Engine's SSD.

The IDEA Engine runs on **Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit)**. The test fleet runs Debian 13 "trixie" (from `agent-engine-dev/docs/PI_FLEET.md`). Its user must be **`pi`**: the Engine lives in `/home/pi/...` and runs as `pi`.

Method A (easiest): NVMe in a USB-M.2 enclosure on your laptop.

1. Install Raspberry Pi Imager on your laptop (Ubuntu: `sudo snap install rpi-imager`). The current version is 2.0.12.
2. **Device:** Raspberry Pi 5. **OS:** Raspberry Pi OS (other) → **Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit)**. **Storage:** the NVMe in the enclosure.
3. Customisation: * **Hostname:** leave the Imager default (`raspberrypi`). The IDEA installer gives the Pi its sticker name in 5.6. * **Localisation:** time zone `Africa/Harare`, keyboard `us` * **User:** username **`pi`**, password `pi911!` (the IDEA `<name>911!` default; SSH stays key-only, so it only works at the keyboard). If Imager asks, **allow passwordless sudo**: the IDEA provisioning script needs it (step 1/5 of the script checks this). * **Wi-Fi:** leave it empty. The Pis use the cable only. * **SSH:** enabled, **public-key authentication only**. Paste your `~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub`. * **Raspberry Pi Connect:** off
4. Write, then fit the NVMe into the HAT.

Method B: no enclosure. If the bootloader is new enough, the Pi 5 **network installer** can run Imager on the Pi itself [12]. Hold **Shift** at power-on, with HDMI, a keyboard and Ethernet with

internet connected. Choose the NVMe as storage and make the same choices as above. (Raspberry Pi docs: "Boot from NVMe" [12].)

✔ **Check:** Imager says "Write successful" and verification passed.

5.3 First boot

Start the Engine and connect to it.

1. Plug the first Engine into switch **port 1** (further Engines into ports 2, 3, 4). The PoE+ HAT powers it. No SD card should be in the slot.
2. Wait 2-3 minutes. In LuCI → **Status → Overview → DHCP leases** you will see a new `raspberrypi` with a temporary address (`10.42.0.1xx`). Do one Pi at a time, so you know which lease is which. The MAC address tells them apart.

✔ **Check:** `ssh pi@10.42.0.1xx` logs in without a password (key only), and then:

```
findmnt /                    # SOURCE must be /dev/nvme0n1p2  -> booted from NVMe
vcgencmd get_throttled       # throttled=0x0 -> power is fine
sudo -n true && echo SUDO-OK # passwordless sudo works
```

If it booted from somewhere else, run `sudo raspi-config` → **Advanced Options → Boot Order → NVMe/USB boot** [12].

5.4 Update the bootloader and the OS

Bring the Engine up to date.

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt full-upgrade -y
sudo rpi-eeprom-update -a
sudo reboot
```

✔ **Check:** after the reboot, `sudo rpi-eeprom-update` says "BOOTLOADER: up to date".

5.5 Engine addresses (no MAC reservations)

How the Engines get their addresses.

You do **not** reserve addresses by MAC. Each Engine tells the router it is an IDEA Engine (DHCP vendor class `idea-engine`), and the router gives it an address from `10.42.0.2` to `10.42.0.9`. So a Pi can move to another school without any change on the router.

1. On the Pi, set the vendor class once (the Engine installer will do this itself, as decided in the router proposal):

```
sudo nmcli connection modify "$(nmcli -g NAME,DEVICE c show --active | grep ':eth0$' | cut -d:
-f1)" \
  ipv4.dhcp-vendor-class-identifier idea-engine
sudo reboot
```

2. In LuCI **Status → Overview → DHCP leases**, note the new address (`10.42.0.2`-`.9`) and write it on the fill-in sheet. Which Engine gets which address is not fixed and does not

matter. Below, `<ENGINE-IP>` means the address of the Engine you are working on (for a one-Engine school this is often `10.42.0.2`).

✔ **Check:** `ping <ENGINE-IP>` answers, for every Engine.

5.6 Install the IDEA Engine (and Console)

Install the IDEA software, so the Console opens at *`http://idea.local`*.

Where this comes from: `koenswings/agent-engine-dev`, read on 12 Oct 2026:

- `README.md`, `docs/SCRIPTS.md`, `docs/PI_FLEET.md`
- `script/provision-fleet.sh`, `script/build-engine.ts`, `config.yaml`

The current, documented way to install a Pi is `script/provision-fleet.sh`. You run it **from your Ubuntu machine** over key-only SSH. It needs nothing but bash and ssh on your side, and it changes nothing on your machine. For each Pi it:

1. checks SSH key login and passwordless sudo;
2. installs apt packages, Node 22.20.0 and the pinned pnpm, and clones `idea`, `agent-engine-dev`, `agent-console-dev` and `agent-app-dev` under `/home/pi/idea/agents/`. It also builds the Console;
3. stores a Tailscale key on the Pi (through stdin, as `/etc/tailscale/debug-authkey`, mode 0600 root), if `--authkey-file` is given;
4. runs `build-engine` on the Pi (Docker, pm2, sudoers, udev, Tailscale in "latent" mode, etc.);
5. waits for the reboot and checks that pm2's `engine` is online and that the Console answers with HTTP 200.

With `auto` instead of a name, the installer makes up a two-word **sticker name** (for example `brave-otter`). It checks that no other Pi on the network, and no Engine in the IDEA database, already has that name. Then it sets it as the Pi's hostname and Engine name.

It takes **15-20 minutes per Pi** and needs internet on the Pi, so do it in Belgium. Install **one Pi per run**, one after the other. Then each new Pi can check its name against the ones already installed.

```
# on your Ubuntu machine
sudo apt install -y git openssh-client
git clone https://github.com/koenswings/agent-engine-dev.git
cd agent-engine-dev
chmod 600 ~/idea-fleet-authkey.txt   # the one fleet key, <TAILSCALE-AUTH-KEY>
./script/provision-fleet.sh --authkey-file ~/idea-fleet-authkey.txt \
    --timezone Africa/Harare --keyboard us  auto=<ENGINE-IP>,model=pi5
# repeat for each further Engine, with its own <ENGINE-IP>, once the previous one is done
```

Put the sticker on the case. Near the end of each run the script prints a line `Sticker name: <STICKER>`. The Pi also keeps it in the file `/home/pi/STICKER.txt` (`ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> cat STICKER.txt`).

1. Write the sticker name on a sticker in large, clear letters. Add the Console address below it: `http://<STICKER>.local`.
2. Stick it on the top of the Pi's case, where you can read it without moving cables.
3. Write the sticker name on the fill-in sheet, next to the Pi's address.

✔ **Check:**

- The script's summary line for each Pi is a success (not `FAILED (...)`).
- For each Engine: `ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> hostname` prints its sticker name, and it matches the sticker on that case.
- For each Engine: `ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> 'pm2 status'` shows `engine` **online**.
- For each Engine: `curl -s -o /dev/null -w '%{http_code}\n' http://<ENGINE-IP>/` prints `200`.
- A laptop on the wired LAN or on the Wi-Fi `IDEA` opens `http://<STICKER>.local` (the name on any sticker) and sees the IDEA Console, with **every** Engine of this school listed.
- The same laptop opens `http://idea.local` and sees the same Console. The Console reads the list of Engines from the IDEA database, so it does not matter which Pi you open.

The Console port is **80**: `config.yaml` → `settings.httpPort: 80` ("serves Console UI").

How `.local` names reach the Wi-Fi. Every Engine offers the extra name `idea.local` on the wired LAN. One Engine holds it at a time; when that Engine stops or is switched off, another one takes it over within seconds (after a power cut, within about two minutes). The router passes `.local` names between the wired LAN and the Wi-Fi networks `IDEA` and `IDEA-Teachers`, so `http://idea.local` and `http://<STICKER>.local` work from the Wi-Fi too. As a backup, the router's own DNS also answers `idea.local` with the Engines' addresses.

> **Use `provision-fleet.sh`.** The older `script/install.sh` is out of date (it clones `koenswings/engine` and sets Node 20). Do not use it. The exact wording of the script's output may still change a little. What counts is the sticker name in the summary and in `STICKER.txt`.

5.6b Report the sticker names to the IDEA team

Tell the IDEA team which Engines this school has.

Send Koen one short message for each school:

School	Pi	Sticker name
(school name)	Engine 1	(sticker name)
(school name)	Engine 2, 3, 4 (if any)	(sticker name)

Send it again whenever a Pi moves to another school. The school is not part of the Pi's name: this report is the only place where the link between Pi and school is kept.

✔ **Check:** Koen confirms that he has the names.

5.7 Tailscale on the Pis (always on, tag:idea)

Let the IDEA team reach the Engines for support.

Join every Engine to the tailnet with the same fleet key and tag, using the sticker name as the Tailscale name:

```
scp ~/idea-fleet-authkey.txt pi@<ENGINE-IP>:/tmp/tskey
ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> 'sudo systemctl enable --now tailscaled && \
  sudo tailscale up --auth-key=file:/tmp/tskey --hostname=<STICKER> \
  --advertise-tags=tag:idea --accept-dns=false && shred -u /tmp/tskey'
```

Repeat for each further Engine, with its own address and sticker name.

✔ **Check:** `ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> tailscale status` shows it online. The Tailscale admin console shows every sticker name with `tag:idea`.

5.8 Apps and content (Kolibri, Nextcloud, Kiwix)

Add the apps and the learning content.

The Engine starts apps from **App Disks**: drives with Docker Compose apps on them, which the Engine detects when you plug them in (`README.md`, `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`).

Koen gives you the App Disks for each school, ready to use. Plug them into the Pis in Belgium and check them there. Download content before you travel: Starlink data and time on site are limited.

✔ **Check:** in the Console, each app shows as Running and opens from a laptop on the LAN.

6. Tailscale policy (Koen, once for all schools)

The one-time remote-access setup for all schools.

Koen manages the tailnet. There is **one** tag and **one** key for the whole fleet, not one per school:

- the tag `tag:idea`, owned by the admins;
- one **fleet auth key** with `tag:idea`: reusable, pre-approved, **not** ephemeral. Koen gives it to the installer **as a file**;
- the access rules: admins reach `tag:idea`, and `tag:idea` reaches nothing.

```
{
  "groups":    { "group:admins": ["<ADMIN-EMAIL-1>", "<ADMIN-EMAIL-2>"] },
  "tagOwners": { "tag:idea": ["group:admins"] },
  "grants": [
    { "src": ["group:admins"], "dst": ["tag:idea"], "ip": ["*"] }
  ]
}
```

There is no rule with `tag:idea` as the source, so a Pi or router cannot reach any other device on the tailnet. A Pi can move to another school with no change here.

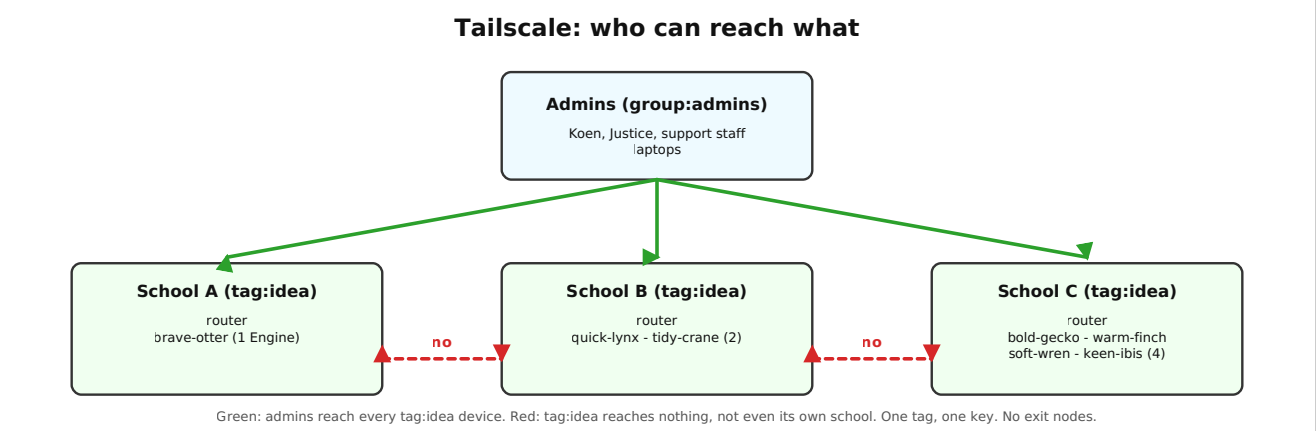


Figure 4. Tailscale access

There are no exit nodes: no device advertises one, and the policy does not grant `autogroup:internet`. Only the people in `group:admins` get access. School staff are not on the list.

✔ **Check:**

- From an admin laptop, `tailscale ping <STICKER>` works.
- From a Pi, `tailscale ping` to any other IDEA device **fails** (no access).

7. On site: connect Starlink and final cabling

Connect everything at the school.

The IDEA School Router – Image and Automated Flashing proposal (Starlink chapter) has the background. In short: Starlink is only the internet on the Cudy **WAN** port. The school network works fully without it.

1. **Install and activate Starlink** with the Starlink app (dish outside with a clear view of the sky). The **IDEA project** owns the Starlink account and pays the subscription; use the project app login Koen gives you. Check that it works with a phone on the Starlink Wi-Fi, and check the app for obstructions. Write the router generation on the fill-in sheet.
2. **Bypass mode:** with the phone still on the Starlink Wi-Fi, open the **Starlink app → Settings → Bypass mode** and switch it on. On a Gen 3 router the light turns violet.

> Bypass mode switches the Starlink Wi-Fi off for good: from now on all Wi-Fi comes from the Cudy. It can only be undone with a factory reset of the Starlink router. Do it last, after Starlink itself works.

3. **Cable 1:** Gen 3 router: remove the rubber cover at the back and connect one of its Ethernet ports to the Cudy **WAN** port. Gen 2 router: Starlink Ethernet Adapter between the router and the dish cable, adapter port to the Cudy WAN. Starlink Mini: its Ethernet cable to the Cudy WAN. Nothing else plugs into the Starlink router.
4. Cable the rest exactly as in the wiring diagram: cable 2 (Cudy LAN1 → switch port 5), then one cable per Engine. Plug in the power adapters: Starlink, Cudy, switch. The Pis start by themselves through PoE.
5. **Power:** if there is a UPS, put the **Cudy, the switch** (and so the Engines) on it. Starlink uses far more power (about 75–100 W); keep it on mains unless the UPS is large.
6. Wait 5 minutes. Leave the Cudy WAN on DHCP and keep bypass on.

✔ **Check:**

- LuCI → **Status → Overview** shows a WAN address from Starlink (normally `100.x.x.x`: that is Starlink's shared address, which is normal and fine for Tailscale).
- `tailscale status` (on your laptop, on the tailnet) shows the router and every Engine's sticker name online.
- The switch's PoE LEDs are on for every port with an Engine.
- Unplug cable 1 for a minute: a laptop on `IDEA` still opens the Console. Plug it back in: Tailscale comes back by itself.

8. Final checklist

Check that everything works before you leave.

Do it once in Belgium (dry run) and again on site. Use a laptop with no other network connection (unplug the cable).

☐	Test	How	Expected
☐	Laptop on **IDEA** opens Console	Join Wi-Fi `IDEA` with `idea911!`, browse to `http://idea.local`	IDEA Console loads, every Engine listed. The laptop has an address `10.42.1.x`.
☐	Console by sticker name	Laptop on Wi-Fi `IDEA`: browse to `http://<STICKER>.local` (each sticker)	Console loads, every Engine listed
☐	Every Engine reachable	Browse to `http://<ENGINE-IP>` for each Engine	Console loads on each
☐	**No internet on IDEA**	Browse to `https://example.com`. In a terminal: `ping -c2 1.1.1.1`, `nslookup example.com 1.1.1.1`	All fail (time-out / refused)
☐	Router admin closed on IDEA	Browse to `http://10.42.1.1` and `http://10.42.0.1`	Fails
☐	Students isolated	From phone A on IDEA, ping laptop B on IDEA	Fails
☐	**Teachers: Pis yes, internet on**	Join `IDEA-Teachers` with `idea-teachers911!`. Open `http://idea.local`, then `https://example.com`	Console yes, internet yes
☐	**Teachers: internet switched off**	Switch off `Teachers-Internet` (section 9), then reload `https://example.com`	Internet stops. Switch it on again: internet works.
☐	Pis have internet (updates)	`ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> 'curl -sI https://deb.debian.org | head -1'`	`HTTP/... 200`
☐	**Every Engine visible in Tailscale**	`tailscale status` on an admin laptop, or the admin console	Every sticker name (and the router) online, tagged `tag:idea`
☐	Stickers and report	Look at every case	Each sticker matches `hostname` on that Pi. Koen has the report (5.6b).
☐	Power fine	`ssh pi@<ENGINE-IP> vcgencmd get_throttled` (for each Engine)	`throttled=0x0`
☐	Reboot test	Pull the switch's power for 10 s, then plug it back in	After about 5 minutes, all of the above pass again

9. Switching teacher internet off and on

Turn internet on the teacher Wi-Fi off or on.

Internet on the teacher Wi-Fi `IDEA-Teachers` is **on** by default. Staff can switch it off, also from far away, and switch it on again later.

LuCI (from a wired laptop at the school, or over Tailscale): **Network → Firewall → Traffic Rules** → `Teachers-Internet` → untick **Enable** to switch it off, or tick it to switch it back on → **Save & Apply**.

SSH:

```
# OFF
ssh root@10.42.0.1 "uci set firewall.teachers_internet.enabled='0' && uci commit firewall &&
service firewall reload"
# ON again (the default)
ssh root@10.42.0.1 "uci set firewall.teachers_internet.enabled='1' && uci commit firewall &&
service firewall reload"
```

✔ **Check:** a teacher laptop on IDEA-Teachers cannot (off) or can (on) open `https://example.com`. Connections that were already open may last a few more seconds.

Switch it on only when the head teacher asks, and off again when the lesson is over. It does not go off by itself.

10. Tell the school, and change the default passwords

Hand over to the school and set new passwords.

Tell the head teacher and the teachers:

- **Students** join Wi-Fi **`IDEA`** with **`idea911!`**. It opens the IDEA Console, Kolibri, Nextcloud and Kiwix, and nothing else: no internet.
- **Teachers** join Wi-Fi **`IDEA-Teachers`** with **`idea-teachers911!`**. It reaches the same apps. Internet is on; staff can switch it off (section 9).
- Teachers keep the `IDEA-Teachers` password to themselves.
- **Opening the Console:** on a classroom computer, click the **IDEA** icon on the desktop or in the dock (IDEA Classroom Computer: Installation Manual). On any other device, type **`http://idea.local`** or **`http://<STICKER>.local`** (the name on any Engine's sticker), and set it as the browser's home page or bookmark it.
- **Default accounts** follow the `<name>911!` convention, for example `admin` / `admin911!`. The student account on the classroom computers, `learner`, has no password.

Change the passwords once the school is running. The defaults are easy on purpose but anyone who knows the pattern can guess them. The head teacher picks new passwords (at least 8 characters, different for students and teachers). The IDEA team, or you over a wired laptop:

1. LuCI → **Network → Wireless** → **Edit** on `IDEA` (both radios) → **Wireless Security → Key** → **Save & Apply**. The same for `IDEA-Teachers`.
2. LuCI → **System → Administration → Router Password** for `root`.
3. On each classroom computer, the `admin` password (`passwd` as admin), and the switch password (section 4).

✔ **Check:** a phone joins with the new password and not with the old one. Every device on that Wi-Fi must join again with the new password.

Appendix A. Router scripts

The scripts that set up the router.

A.1 `docs/manuals/install/scripts/school-router-setup.sh`

Sets up the IDEA networks on the router.

```
#!/bin/sh
# school-router-setup.sh - IDEA school router settings for OpenWrt 25.12 on a Cudy WR3000S v1
#
# What it does: LAN 10.42.0.1/24, two Wi-Fi networks in their own firewall zones
# ('IDEA' = students 10.42.1.0/24, 'IDEA-Teachers' = teachers 10.42.2.0/24),
# Engine addresses .2-.9 by DHCP vendor class 'idea-engine' (no MAC reservations),
# the switch at .10 (optional MAC), and the firewall rules.
# The pre-flashed IDEA router image (router image and flashing proposal, idea#209)
# already has all of this; use this script only to set up a router by hand.
# It does NOT install Tailscale (see manual Appendix D.2.7).
#
# 1. Edit the values below on your laptop. NEVER commit real passwords to git.
# 2. Copy it:   scp -O school-router-setup.sh root@192.168.1.1:/tmp/
# 3. Run it:    ssh root@192.168.1.1 'sh /tmp/school-router-setup.sh'
#    The router reboots at the end and comes back on 10.42.0.1.
set -e

NET_PREFIX='10.42'                        # the same at every school (no school numbers)
SWITCH_MAC=''                             # TL-SG105PE MAC from its label (optional)
STUDENT_WIFI_KEY='idea911!'               # IDEA default (<name>911!); the school changes it later
TEACHER_WIFI_KEY='idea-teachers911!'      # IDEA default; the school changes it later
COUNTRY='ZW'                              # Wi-Fi regulatory country (Zimbabwe)


# ---- system ------------------------------------------------------------
uci set system.@system[0].hostname="idea-router"
uci set system.@system[0].zonename='Africa/Harare'
uci set system.@system[0].timezone='CAT-2'

# ---- wired LAN (router, Pis, switch) -----------------------------------
uci set network.lan.ipaddr="$NET_PREFIX.0.1"
uci set network.lan.netmask='255.255.255.0'
uci set dhcp.lan.start='100'              # pool .100-.199; .2-.99 kept for fixed devices
uci set dhcp.lan.limit='100'

# ---- the two Wi-Fi networks: bridge + interface + DHCP -----------------
for Z in students teachers; do
  if [ "$Z" = students ]; then NET=1; else NET=2; fi
  uci -q delete network.${Z}_dev || true
  uci set network.${Z}_dev=device
  uci set network.${Z}_dev.type='bridge'
  uci set network.${Z}_dev.name="br-$Z"
  uci -q delete network.$Z || true
  uci set network.$Z=interface
  uci set network.$Z.proto='static'
  uci set network.$Z.device="br-$Z"
  uci set network.$Z.ipaddr="$NET_PREFIX.$NET.1"
  uci set network.$Z.netmask='255.255.255.0'
  uci -q delete dhcp.$Z || true
```

```
  uci set dhcp.$Z=dhcp
  uci set dhcp.$Z.interface="$Z"
  uci set dhcp.$Z.start='10'
  uci set dhcp.$Z.limit='240'
  uci set dhcp.$Z.leasetime='2h'
done

# ---- Engines: fixed range by DHCP vendor class, no MAC reservations -------------
# Each Engine sends vendor class 'idea-engine' and gets an address in .2-.9 (proposal 5.1).
sed -i '/# IDEA engines/,+2d' /etc/dnsmasq.conf 2>/dev/null || true
cat >> /etc/dnsmasq.conf <<DNSMASQ
# IDEA engines
dhcp-vendorclass=set:engine,idea-engine
dhcp-range=tag:engine,$NET_PREFIX.0.2,$NET_PREFIX.0.9,255.255.255.0,12h
DNSMASQ
uci -q delete dhcp.pi1 || true
uci -q delete dhcp.pi2 || true
if [ -n "$SWITCH_MAC" ]; then
  uci -q delete dhcp.switch || true
  uci set dhcp.switch=host
  uci set dhcp.switch.mac="$SWITCH_MAC"
  uci set dhcp.switch.ip="$NET_PREFIX.0.10"
fi

# ---- Wi-Fi: same two SSIDs on 2.4 GHz (radio0) and 5 GHz (radio1) -------------
for R in 0 1; do
  uci set wireless.radio$R.country="$COUNTRY"
  uci set wireless.radio$R.disabled='0'
  uci -q delete wireless.default_radio$R || true
  uci -q delete wireless.idea_s$R || true
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R=wifi-iface
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.device="radio$R"
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.mode='ap'
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.network='students'
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.ssid='IDEA'
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.encryption='psk2'
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.key="$STUDENT_WIFI_KEY"
  uci set wireless.idea_s$R.isolate='1'          # students cannot reach each other's devices
  uci -q delete wireless.idea_t$R || true
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R=wifi-iface
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.device="radio$R"
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.mode='ap'
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.network='teachers'
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.ssid='IDEA-Teachers'
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.encryption='psk2'
  uci set wireless.idea_t$R.key="$TEACHER_WIFI_KEY"
done

# ---- firewall zones -------------------------------------------------------------
for Z in students teachers; do
  uci -q delete firewall.$Z || true
  uci set firewall.$Z=zone
  uci set firewall.$Z.name="$Z"
  uci add_list firewall.$Z.network="$Z"
  uci set firewall.$Z.input='REJECT'      # router itself: only DHCP + DNS (rules below)
  uci set firewall.$Z.output='ACCEPT'
  uci set firewall.$Z.forward='REJECT'
  # NOTE: no 'forwarding' section to wan -> no internet, no outside DNS, no VPNs

  uci -q delete firewall.${Z}_dhcp || true
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp=rule
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.name="Allow-DHCP-$Z"
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.src="$Z"
```

```
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.proto='udp'
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.dest_port='67'
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.family='ipv4'
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dhcp.target='ACCEPT'

  uci -q delete firewall.${Z}_dns || true
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns=rule
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns.name="Allow-DNS-$Z"
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns.src="$Z"
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns.proto='tcp udp'
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns.dest_port='53'
  uci set firewall.${Z}_dns.target='ACCEPT'

  S="${Z}_engines"
  uci -q delete firewall.${Z}_pi1 || true
  uci -q delete firewall.${Z}_pi2 || true
  uci -q delete firewall.$S || true
  uci set firewall.$S=rule
  uci set firewall.$S.name="Allow-$Z-to-Engines"
  uci set firewall.$S.src="$Z"
  uci set firewall.$S.dest='lan'
  uci add_list firewall.$S.dest_ip="$NET_PREFIX.0.0/29"   # .2-.7 (.0/.1 are not Engines)
  uci add_list firewall.$S.dest_ip="$NET_PREFIX.0.8/31"   # .8-.9; the switch at .10 stays closed
  uci set firewall.$S.proto='all'
  uci set firewall.$S.target='ACCEPT'
done

# ---- the ONE switchable rule: teachers -> internet (starts ON; staff can disable remotely)
-------------------
uci -q delete firewall.teachers_internet || true
uci set firewall.teachers_internet=rule
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.name='Teachers-Internet'
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.src='teachers'
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.dest='wan'
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.proto='all'
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.target='ACCEPT'
uci set firewall.teachers_internet.enabled='1'

uci commit
echo "Saved. Rebooting now. Reconnect your laptop cable to LAN2-LAN4 and open http://
$NET_PREFIX.0.1"
reboot
```

A.2 `docs/manuals/install/scripts/router-tailscale-zone.sh`

Lets Tailscale reach the school network.

```
#!/bin/sh
# router-tailscale-zone.sh - give tailscale0 its own firewall zone on the school router
# (OpenWrt wiki "Tailscale", Initial Setup). Admins on the tailnet may reach the router
# itself (LuCI/SSH); nothing is forwarded (no subnet routes, no exit node).
set -e
uci -q delete network.tailscale || true
uci set network.tailscale=interface
uci set network.tailscale.proto='none'
uci set network.tailscale.device='tailscale0'
uci -q delete firewall.tailscale || true
uci set firewall.tailscale=zone
uci set firewall.tailscale.name='tailscale'
uci add_list firewall.tailscale.network='tailscale'
```

```
uci set firewall.tailscale.input='ACCEPT'
uci set firewall.tailscale.output='ACCEPT'
uci set firewall.tailscale.forward='REJECT'
uci commit
/etc/init.d/network reload
/etc/init.d/firewall restart
echo "tailscale zone ready"
```

A.3 docs/manuals/install/scripts/router-starlink-cgnat-exception.sh

Lets the Starlink router's own address through.

```
#!/bin/sh
# router-starlink-cgnat-exception.sh — narrow WAN DHCP exception before Tailscale's
# CGNAT drop (idea#209 D10). Starlink (and other CGNAT ISPs) put the DHCP server in
# 100.64.0.0/10; Tailscale's ts-input rule otherwise drops DHCPACK and the WAN lease
# fails to renew. Inserts UDP 67→68 accept on wan before the drop, and re-applies it
# from a hotplug script when interfaces come up (tailscaled rebuilds ts-input).
# Safe to run more than once. Source: tailscale/tailscale#12828.
set -e

HELPER=/usr/libexec/idea-cgnat-dhcp-exception.sh
HOTPLUG=/etc/hotplug.d/iface/90-idea-cgnat-dhcp

mkdir -p /usr/libexec /etc/hotplug.d/iface

cat > "$HELPER" << 'HELPER'
#!/bin/sh
# Accept WAN DHCP replies (UDP 67→68) before Tailscale's 100.64.0.0/10 drop in ts-input.
# No-op if nft or the chain is not ready yet.
command -v nft >/dev/null 2>&1 || exit 0
nft list chain ip filter ts-input >/dev/null 2>&1 || exit 0
if nft list chain ip filter ts-input 2>/dev/null | grep -q 'udp sport 67 udp dport 68'; then
    exit 0
fi
nft insert rule ip filter ts-input iifname "wan" udp sport 67 udp dport 68 counter accept
HELPER
chmod 755 "$HELPER"

cat > "$HOTPLUG" << EOF
#!/bin/sh
[ "\$ACTION" = ifup ] || exit 0
# Re-apply after wan or tailscale0 comes up; tailscaled rebuilds ts-input on start.
sleep 2
$HELPER
EOF
chmod 755 "$HOTPLUG"

"$HELPER"
echo "Starlink CGNAT DHCP exception installed (D10)"
```

Appendix B. Troubleshooting

Quick fixes for common problems.

Problem	Try
No LuCI after the first upload	That is normal: there is no Wi-Fi. Use a cable to a LAN port, set your laptop to DHCP and open `http://192.168.1.1`.
Cudy won't accept the intermediate image	Check the MD5. Upload the unzipped `.bin`, then try again [1].
The router seems "bricked"	Reset (hold 10 s after boot) [1]. Otherwise use Cudy TFTP recovery with a **recent** stock image (2.4.6 / 2.5.30 for new-flash units) [1][2].
A Pi does not start	Check the PoE LED on that switch port and swap the cable. Try another PoE+ port.
`throttled` is not `0x0`	Power problem: check the cable and HAT and switch budget. See the 5.1 USB power box.
Console doesn't load from Wi-Fi but does from LAN	Check the rules `Allow-students-to-Engines`. Is the Pi in `10.42.0.2-.9` (5.5)? Try `http://<STICKER>.local` as well as `http://idea.local`: if only one of them fails, tell the IDEA team which one.
Tailscale offline after a move	`ssh` in and run `tailscale status`. Check the WAN on the router. Starlink must be in bypass mode.

Appendix C. Sources (read on 12 October 2026)

Where the facts in this manual come from.

1. OpenWrt wiki, Cudy WR3000S v1: `https://openwrt.org/toh/cudy/wr3000s_v1` (installation, flash chip notice, MD5, backup, layout).
2. Cudy, OpenWrt Software Download (Transition Firmware notice): `https://www.cudy.com/blogs/faq/openwrt-software-download`.
3. OpenWrt Firmware Selector: `https://firmware-selector.openwrt.org/?target=mediatek%2Ffilogic&id=cudy_wr3000s-v1`.
4. OpenWrt 25.12.5 `profiles.json` (filogic): `https://downloads.openwrt.org/releases/25.12.5/targets/mediatek/filogic/profiles.json`.
5. OpenWrt wiki, Tailscale: `https://openwrt.org/docs/guide-user/services/vpn/tailscale/start`.
6. OpenWrt 25.12.5 package index (aarch64_cortex-a53): `tailscale-1.102.3-r1.apk`.
7. TP-Link TL-SG105PE product page: `https://www.tp-link.com/us/business-networking/poe-switch/tl-sg105pe/`.
8. TP-Link Easy Smart switch Installation Guide / User Guide (default IP, PoE Auto Recovery defaults, PoE MAX LED).
9. Raspberry Pi documentation, Power supply (USB current limits): `raspberrypi.com/documentation/computers/raspberry-pi.html#power-supply`.
10. Waveshare wiki, PoE M.2 HAT+ (5 V 4.5 A max): `https://www.waveshare.com/wiki/PoE_M.2_HAT+`.
11. Raspberry Pi documentation, Bootloader configuration: `PSU_MAX_CURRENT`.
12. Raspberry Pi documentation, M.2 HAT+ → Boot from NVMe: `raspberrypi.com/documentation/accessories/m2-hat-plus.html`.
13. IDEA repos (read only): `koenswings/agent-engine-dev` (`README.md`, `docs/SCRIPTS.md`, `docs/PI_FLEET.md`, `script/provision-fleet.sh`, `config.yaml`) and `koenswings/idea` (`proposals/tailscale-remote-management.md`, `tools/fleet/*`).

Appendix D. Flashing and setting up a router by hand

Prepare a router yourself if it did not arrive pre-flashed.

Only for a Cudy WR3000S v1 that did **not** arrive pre-flashed. The flash script of the IDEA School Router – Image and Automated Flashing proposal does the same steps automatically.

D.1 Router: check model, version and flash chip

Make sure the router can take OpenWrt.

D.1.1 Read the label

Find the model and hardware version.

1. Turn the Cudy over. The label shows the model (**WR3000S**), the hardware version (**V1.0**) and the serial number.
2. If it says anything other than WR3000S V1.x, **stop**. The images below are only for WR3000S v1. (WR3000, WR3000H, WR3000E and WR3000P are different devices with different images.)
3. Find the **date code** in the serial number. The OpenWrt wiki explains it [1]: serials that start with `S000` have the build year and week (YYWW) in characters 9 to 12. For example `S000xxxx2611xxxxx` was built in 2026, week 11.

> **New flash chip (date code 2543 or later, so from November 2025).** These units have a different flash chip (ESMT F50L1G41LC). Per the OpenWrt wiki [1] and Cudy's notice [2] you must use the **new** Cudy-signed intermediate image (the 20251119 build), and OpenWrt 24.10.5 or later. 25.12.5 is fine. Keep these units away from Cudy stock firmware 2.3.x or older. **If you are not sure, treat the unit as a new-flash unit.**

✔ **Check:** you know the model (WR3000S), version (V1) and date code (old or new flash).

D.1.2 Download the two files (on your laptop)

Get the two firmware files.

File	Where	How to check it
Cudy-signed intermediate image: `WR3000S 1.0.zip`. Unzip it and use the `.bin` inside, **not** the .zip. As of Sept 2026 it is `cudy_wr3000s-v1-sysupgrade_20251119.bin`.	Cudy's Google Drive folder, linked from the OpenWrt wiki [1] and Cudy's "OpenWrt Software Download" page [2]	Size 14,945,872 bytes, MD5 `403e276f` Run `md5sum` on the file. The WR3000H/ name, so check the MD5!

File	Where	How to check it
Official OpenWrt 25.12.5 sysupgrade image: `openwrt-25.12.5-mediatek-filogic-cudy_wr3000s-v1-squashfs-sysupgrade.bin`	Firmware Selector [3]: `firmware-selector.openwrt.org/?target=mediatek%2Ffilogic&id=cudy_wr3000s-v1`	SHA-256 `b0a26c80fa458b4b743508a6a6de8aa9d1` (from OpenWrt's `profiles.json` [4]). F

> Do **not** pick the `...-ubootmod-...` files. That is an advanced layout which only a serial cable can undo [1].

✔ **Check:** `md5sum cudy_wr3000s-v1-sysupgrade_20251119.bin` and `sha256sum openwrt-25.12.5-...-sysupgrade.bin` print exactly the values above.

D.2 Router: flash OpenWrt and configure it

Install OpenWrt and the IDEA settings.

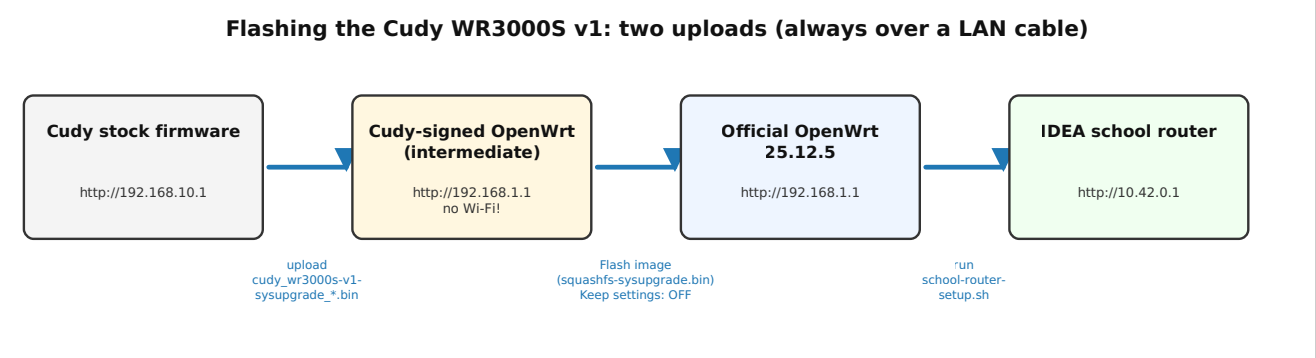


Figure 5. Flashing in two uploads

Do all of this with a **network cable** between your laptop and a Cudy **LAN** port. After the first upload the router has no Wi-Fi at all, which can look as if it is broken [1].

D.2.1 First upload: Cudy-signed intermediate image (source: OpenWrt wiki [1])

Load the intermediate image that makes OpenWrt possible.

1. Connect the 12 V adapter. Connect your laptop to **LAN2**. Leave WAN empty.
2. Browse to `http://192.168.10.1` (or `http://cudy.net`). Recent stock firmware (2.4.6) asks you to **create an admin password** first [1]. Pick any password: this firmware will be replaced in a moment.
3. If a setup wizard turns on automatic upgrades, switch that off [1].
4. Go to **Advanced Settings → Firmware** (on 2.4.6 the upload is called **Local Update**). Upload the unzipped `.bin` intermediate image.
5. If the confirmation screen shows an MD5, compare it with `403e276f...1a137`. Confirm and wait 3-5 minutes, with the power connected.

✔ **Check:** your laptop gets an address `192.168.1.x`. `http://192.168.1.1` opens an OpenWrt LuCI page that says "OpenWrt 23.05-SNAPSHOT-CUDY" [1]. There is no Wi-Fi network: that is normal.

> "File is invalid"? Others have seen this too [1]. Check the MD5 and make sure you uploaded the `.bin`, not the `.zip`. Then try again.

D.2.2 Back up the per-unit calibration data (recommended, 2 minutes)

Keep a copy of the router's own radio data.

The OpenWrt wiki [1] recommends saving the `Factory` and `bdinfo` partitions now. They hold this unit's own Wi-Fi calibration and MAC address, and no download can replace them. The intermediate image runs SSH as `root` with no password. From your Ubuntu machine:

```
mkdir -p ~/idea-backups/<CUDY-SERIAL> && cd ~/idea-backups/<CUDY-SERIAL>
ssh root@192.168.1.1 'cat /dev/mtd2' > Factory.bin
ssh root@192.168.1.1 'cat /dev/mtd3' > bdinfo.bin
ssh root@192.168.1.1 'sha256sum /dev/mtd2 /dev/mtd3'
sha256sum Factory.bin bdinfo.bin
```

✔ **Check:** the two hash pairs match.

D.2.3 Second upload: official OpenWrt 25.12.5

Install the official OpenWrt.

Option A (web): in LuCI at `http://192.168.1.1` go to **System → Backup / Flash Firmware → Flash image**. Pick `openwrt-25.12.5-mediatek-filogic-cudy_wr3000s-v1-squashfs-sysupgrade.bin`. **Untick "Keep settings"** [1]. Continue and wait 3-5 minutes.

Option B (command line), which the wiki [1] also gives:

```
scp -O openwrt-25.12.5-mediatek-filogic-cudy_wr3000s-v1-squashfs-sysupgrade.bin root@192.168.1.1:/
tmp/
ssh root@192.168.1.1 'sysupgrade -n /tmp/openwrt-25.12.5-mediatek-filogic-cudy_wr3000s-v1-
squashfs-sysupgrade.bin'
```

(`-O` makes scp use the old protocol, which OpenWrt needs. `-n` means "do not keep settings".)

✔ **Check:** after a reboot, `http://192.168.1.1` shows LuCI with **"OpenWrt 25.12.5"** at the bottom. **Status → Overview** says Model: Cudy WR3000S v1.

D.2.4 Set the router root password

Protect the router with a password.

1. LuCI: **System → Administration → Router Password**. Enter the IDEA default `admin911!` twice and save. (Or run `passwd` over SSH.)
2. Optional but good: in **System → Administration → SSH-Keys**, add your SSH public key.

✔ **Check:** log out of LuCI and log in again with the new password. `ssh root@192.168.1.1` asks for the password (or uses your key).

D.2.5 Apply the IDEA school settings (script)

Run the IDEA settings script.

The script `scripts/school-router-setup.sh` (full text in Appendix A) sets everything up in one go:

- LAN `10.42.0.1/24`, with the DHCP pool at `.100-.199`
- the `students` and `teachers` networks and zones
- both SSIDs on 2.4 and 5 GHz, Wi-Fi country `ZW`
- Engine addresses `.2-.9` by DHCP vendor class (no MAC reservations) and the switch at `.10`
- the firewall rules, including `Teachers-Internet` (on)

It was tested with OpenWrt 25.12.5's `uci` and `fw4` (rule set rendered and checked), but not yet on a real Cudy.

1. The script already has the IDEA default Wi-Fi passwords (`idea911!`, `idea-teachers911!`). Optionally fill in the switch MAC.
2. Copy it to the router and run it:

```
scp -O school-router-setup.sh root@192.168.1.1:/tmp/
ssh root@192.168.1.1 'sh /tmp/school-router-setup.sh'
```

3. The router reboots. Unplug and replug your laptop cable (or renew DHCP).

✔ **Check (all four):**

- Your laptop gets `10.42.0.1xx`. `http://10.42.0.1` opens LuCI.
- **Network → Wireless** lists `IDEA` and `IDEA-Teachers` on both radios, all enabled.
- **Network → Firewall → Zones** lists `lan`, `wan`, `students`, `teachers`. The `students` and `teachers` zones have Input: reject, Forward: reject and no "allow forward to wan".
- **Network → Firewall → Traffic Rules** lists `Allow-students-to-Engines`, `Allow-teachers-to-Engines`, the DHCP/DNS rules and `Teachers-Internet` (ticked = on, the default).

> If you prefer clicking, every setting in the script can also be made in LuCI. The script is just faster and the same for every school. To change one value later, for example a Wi-Fi password, use LuCI (**Network → Wireless → Edit**).

D.2.6 Connect WAN and test internet on the router

Check that the router reaches the internet.

1. Plug your home router (Belgium) or the Starlink router (on site) into the Cudy **WAN** port.
2. LuCI **Status → Overview** should show an IPv4 WAN address.

✔ **Check:** `ssh root@10.42.0.1 'ping -c3 openwrt.org'` gets replies.

D.2.7 Install Tailscale on the router

Let the IDEA team reach the router for support.

Source: OpenWrt wiki "Tailscale" [5]. OpenWrt 25.12 uses the `apk` package manager (not `opkg`). Release 25.12.5 ships `tailscale 1.102.3` [6].

1. Check there is space: `ssh root@10.42.0.1 'df -h /overlay'`. The wiki says about 48 MiB is free after install [1]. Tailscale needs about 20-30 MB.
2. Install it and start it:

```
ssh root@10.42.0.1
apk update
apk add tailscale
/etc/init.d/tailscale enable
/etc/init.d/tailscale start
```

3. Copy the key **file** that Koen gave you to the router's RAM disk (it is gone after a reboot) and join the tailnet. On your laptop:

```
chmod 600 ~/idea-fleet-authkey.txt     # contains <TAILSCALE-AUTH-KEY>, one line
scp -O ~/idea-fleet-authkey.txt root@10.42.0.1:/tmp/tskey
ssh root@10.42.0.1 'tailscale up --auth-key=file:/tmp/tskey --hostname=router-<CUDY-SERIAL> \
   --advertise-tags=tag:idea --accept-dns=false && rm -f /tmp/tskey'
```

4. Give `tailscale0` its own firewall zone so that admins can reach the router over Tailscale. Use `scripts/router-tailscale-zone.sh` (Appendix A.2): copy it with `scp -O` and run it with `sh`. It follows the wiki's "unmanaged interface + zone" recipe [5], except that it has **no forwarding** and no masquerading, because we don't route.
5. **Starlink CGNAT DHCP exception.** Tailscale drops packets from `100.64.0.0/10` that do not arrive on `tailscale0`. Starlink's DHCP server is in that range, so without an exception DHCP renewals fail and the WAN briefly drops each lease period. Install the narrow exception (WAN UDP 67→68 accept before the drop, re-applied by hotplug):

```
scp -O router-starlink-cgnat-exception.sh root@10.42.0.1:/tmp/
ssh root@10.42.0.1 'sh /tmp/router-starlink-cgnat-exception.sh'
```

✔ **Check:** `ssh root@10.42.0.1 "nft list chain ip filter ts-input"` shows a rule `iifname "wan" udp sport 67 udp dport 68 … accept` **above** the `100.64.0.0/10` drop. On Starlink, leave the router for one lease period (or force a renew) and confirm the WAN address stays up.

> Leave out `--advertise-routes` and `--advertise-exit-node`: IDEA uses neither subnet routers nor exit nodes. Use `file:` after `--auth-key=`, not the key itself, so the key does not end up in the shell history or the process list (the same rule as in the IDEA Engine).

✔ **Check:** `ssh root@10.42.0.1 tailscale status` shows the router online. In the Tailscale admin console, the machine `router-<CUDY-SERIAL>` has tag `tag:idea`. From your laptop on the tailnet, `ssh root@<router-tailscale-ip>` works.

> The `file:` form of `--auth-key` is the one the IDEA Engine's `tailscale-debug-activate.sh` uses. Tagged devices have key expiry switched off by default in Tailscale, so the router stays on the tailnet after the auth key itself expires. The IDEA router image bakes in the same CGNAT exception; this hand step is only for Appendix D.